

Tablets with Calling Facility

Calling facility (via SIM slot) on tablets offers you the opportunity to invest in a single device, rather than a smartphone and a tablet separately, and get entertainment and connectivity while on the go. If you wish to buy a calling tablet device, make sure you consider the guidelines given in this article



S. AADEETYA

Over the years, tablets have evolved into various form factors. A lot of domestic and international players have emerged in the tablet market but one cannot deny that Apple is still the heavyweight of the segment with its revolutionary iPad. The first iPad was launched a few years ago and the market has grown and evolved in many ways since then. The technology has improved, which has led other manufacturers to try their hands at the portable slates, fondly called tablet PCs.

Various brands have tried replicating the formula that Apple has successfully devised but only a handful of them have been able to come close to the Cupertino giant. Interestingly, these options are available at a much lower price than Apple's tablets.

Amazon started the trend with its Kindle Fire tablet. Google perfected the art with Google Nexus 7 and Nexus 10 tablets, and even Samsung's varied Galaxy Tab 2 range attained market success with its multiple display platforms. It did not take long for tablets to become the 'primary' device. These came and evolved as a replacement for laptops as they remain connected on the go. That's not all. Tablets have even become a threat to smartphones with their calling facility. With the aim of encashing on the craze of tablets, the OEMs started adding SIM slots to their devices, to enable the calling facility.

Introduction of calling facility (via SIM slot) on tablets offered consumers the opportunity to invest in one good

device, rather than a smartphone and a tablet separately, and get entertainment and connectivity while on the go. The advent of 2G and 3G connections led to the launch of dual-SIM tablets.

Dual-SIM tablets are designed on the lines of smartphones, but with a different form factor. The basic purpose behind a dual-SIM-based tablet is to offer 2G and 3G facility, both via SIM. Of course, in this case, an external dongle is not needed for connectivity purposes.

If you wish to buy a calling tablet device, make sure you consider the guidelines given below.

Why do you need a tablet?

Tablets are bigger than smartphones and offer more options in terms of content viewing. One cannot deny that the bigger the form factor, the better the scope for work or entertainment.

Before you invest in a tablet PC, make sure you have your requirements in place. Tablets are a good choice if you want a display slate to watch movies, surf Web and do other media-centric activities. A 17.7cm (7 inches) device is a good choice for these purposes. But if you are a frequent business traveller who needs to carry a portable device for short presentations, or even getting work done on the go, you could probably consider a 25.4cm (10 inches) option.

Tablet maker matters

Before you buy a tablet, do enough research about the maker of the device, its warranty, after-sales service, *et al.* Make sure the manufacturer has an effective after-sales set-up in the region or country. If you are buying an Android tablet, one aspect that you need to keep in mind is the frequency of software updates. A manufacturer that is giving you frequent software updates is definitely worth consideration.

Varied tablet sizes

Going by the industry standards, tablets with screen sizes measuring 17.7 cm (7 inches) to 20.3 cm (8 inches) diagonally across the screen are categorised as small devices. Tablets of these sizes are usually priced affordably but come under-powered as compared to their larger counterparts. However, small tablets are much more portable and fit in pockets easily.